



HOW LEADING ORGANISATIONS ARE APPROACHING HYBRID WORK

	AMAZON INDIA ▶ Workforce comprises Prime Video, operations team, technology team, Alexa Labs and AWS. Onus on the team leader to decide how many days they need to work from office or home
	GOOGLE INDIA ▶ Three days in office, two days wherever they work best ▶ Flexible work arrangements: Temporarily work from a location other than their main office for up to four weeks a year
	DHL EXPRESS (INDIA) ▶ Started 50:50 hybrid model which includes working from home for 10 days in a month since March ▶ Plans to let employees work from an office location nearest to them as the company is present in 52 locations
	HUL ▶ Recently moved back to hybrid work model ▶ Employees encouraged to come to office /work the market for at least three days a week
	TATA CONSUMER PRODUCTS ▶ Hybrid model: Work from office, work from home or work from anywhere ▶ Office capacity capped at 50 per cent
	DELOITTE INDIA ▶ Moved to hybrid model from early March ▶ Each business and service line can choose the approach that best aligns with their unique requirements

per cent were made for permanent remote jobs during the same time, with the highest search count of over 350,000 in December 2021 alone.

BUT IT'S NOT JUST the fear of the virus holding people back anymore, going by the crowds at the malls, theatres and restaurants. Tech giant Google's *Covid-19 Community Mobility Reports* map community movement in India and other countries during the pandemic (February 17, 2020 to March 3, 2022) using data from users who have turned on their location history. From mid-June 2020 to mid-October 2021, the trend graph for community movement in India to retail and recreation spots dipped the lowest from the baseline, while the movement to workplaces stayed well above it, meaning that people went out more to workplaces than to places like restaurants and shopping centres. But the trend reversed during mid-October to December 2021, when movement to retail and recreation spots overtook the movement to workplaces. Going to the workplace may be a response to official mandates, but visits to recreational spots are completely voluntary, indicating a greater level of confidence among people to step out. It may just be a question of convenience as well, with several employees blaming time-consuming commute for not wanting to return.

"A small minority of employees has referenced time spent in commute as well as the nature of their roles—being such that they can be delivered remotely—as reasons to not come back to office," says TCP's Chincho-likar. He adds that most requests are not so much around working from their home town but about flexibility in schedules. Deloitte's Nathan also mentions commute timings and the effort and costs involved in relocation from home towns as key concerns employees have about returning to office. Careernet's Das says his firm surveyed 2,000 employees and found a 50-50 split of those wanting to return to work and those who don't. Among those who don't, time and money saved on travel and stay were prominent reasons, he says. "And they are okay to work from 9 am to 9 pm with small breaks in between to attend to their life, which they can't do while at office full time."

Take the case of communications profes-